

Cornifer guentheri

Gunther's triangle frog

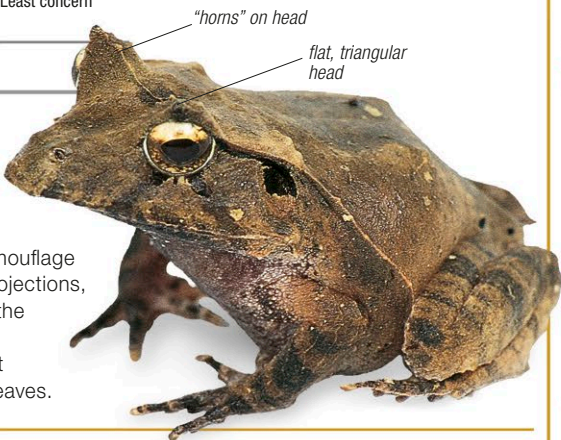


Length 2–3¼ in (5–8 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season
season
Status Least concern

Location Solomon Islands



This forest-floor animal strongly resembles the Asian spadefoot toad (see p.451), although it is not closely related. It also uses the same kind of camouflage to avoid being seen: its projections, or "horns," help break up the outline of the frog's head, making it difficult to detect against a background of leaves.



Ptychadena oxyrhynchus

Sharp-nosed grass frog



Length 1½–2¼ in (4–7 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Spring season
Status Least concern

Location W. and C. to southern Africa



This highly athletic frog can move very fast through grass and in water, its powerful hind legs enabling it to take prodigious leaps. It is yellowish brown above, with brown or black spots and patches, and has a white underside. A pale triangular patch is present on the



Mantella viridis

Green mantella

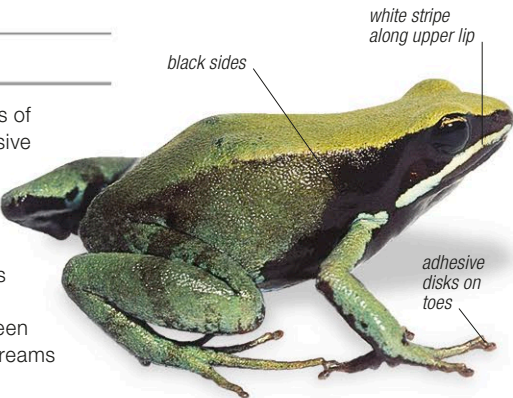


Length ¾–1¼ in (2–3 cm)
Habit Wholly terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season
season
Status Endangered

Location N. and E. Madagascar



The mantellas are 16 species of brightly colored frogs, exclusive to Madagascar, which are all threatened with extinction due mainly to the destruction of their forest habitat. Their numbers are further depleted by the worldwide pet trade. The green mantella, which lives near streams



in tropical forest, is yellow or pale green on its back and head, black along its sides, and has a white stripe running along its upper lip. Active during the day, it feeds on insects and other invertebrates. The male calls out with a series of clicks to attract the female. After mating, which takes place on land during the rainy season, the female lays eggs close to streams.

Cornifer vitiensis

Fiji tree frog



Length 1½–2 in (3.5–5 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Spring and summer
season
Status Near threatened

Location Fiji



The Fiji tree frog is a slender-bodied amphibian that is encountered only in the tropical forests of Fiji. It has a flat head with large eardrums, wrinkled skin, and adhesive disks on its

unwebbed fingers and toes. The female lays a small number of large eggs on the ground, which hatch directly into small froglets, the tadpole phase being completed within the egg. Little is known about the behavior and life cycle of this frog.



Pyxicephalus adspersus

African bullfrog



Length 3¼–9 in (8–23 cm)
Habit Mostly terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season
season
Status Least concern

Location C. to southern Africa



The African bullfrog inhabits wet and dry savanna, where it may remain buried underground for very long periods, even up to several years if there is no heavy rain. When

underground, it encases itself in a cocoon that reduces water loss. It feeds on other frogs as well as insects and other invertebrates. This bullfrog is very large, with a massive head and horny tubercles on its hind feet, for digging. During the breeding season, the male, which is larger than the female, develops a pair of toothlike tusks on the lower jaw, which he uses in fights over territory with other males. He produces a loud, booming call to attract the female. After mating in flooded pools, the male guards both the eggs and the tadpoles. As the tadpoles develop, the male digs channels to enable them to swim away to larger expanses of water.



Mantella aurantiaca

Madagascan golden mantella



Length ¾–1¼ in (2–3 cm)
Habit Wholly terrestrial
Breeding Rainy season
season
Status Critically endangered

Location W. central Madagascar



Strikingly similar to poison-dart frogs (see p.460), which live in the American tropics, this Madagascan frog has evolved bright colors to warn predators

that it is toxic. Active during the day, it searches for small animals on the forest floor. During the breeding season, adults mate on land, and females lay their eggs in moist leaf litter. Once the tadpoles have hatched, they are swept into pools by rain. Like other mantellas, this species is threatened by deforestation.

